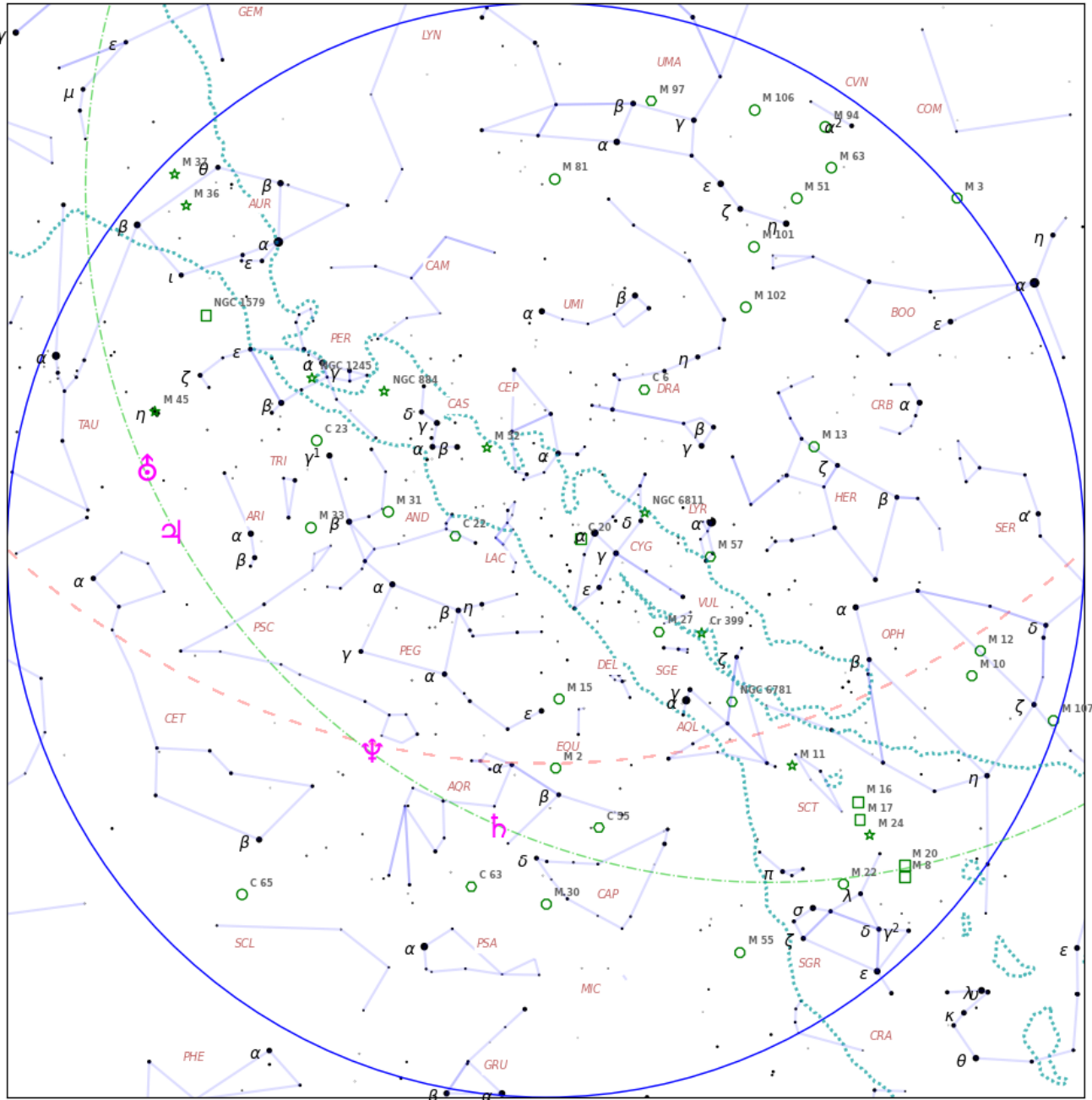


OCTOBER



Check out Fall skies: constellations, planets, and bright star clusters and the Milky Way are all visible this month. At the end of the month we have the Orionid meteor shower.

October 2023 skies

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Lady*
 AQL - Aquila - *the Eagle*
 AQR - Aquarius - *the Water Bearer*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAP - Capricornus - *the Horned Goat*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DEL - Delphinus - *the Dolphin*
 EQU - Equuleus - *the Little Horse*
 GRU - Grus - *the Crane*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - Lyra - *the Harp*
 MIC - Microscopium - *the Microscope*
 OPH - Ophiuchus - *the Serpent Bearer*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PSA - Piscis Australis - *the Southern Fish*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 SCL - Sculptor - *the Sculptor's Workshop*
 SCT - Scutum - *the Shield*
 SER - Serpens - *the Snake*
 SGE = Sagitta - *the Arrow*
 SGR - Sagittarius - *the Archer*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VUL - Vulpecula - *the Little Fox*

Planets

♃ - Jupiter, ♄ - Saturn,
 ♅ - Uranus, ♆ - Neptune

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right.

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time of this chart changes slowly over time, becoming roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Date	Time
Oct 1	10 PM
Oct 8	9:30 PM
Oct 15	9 PM
Oct 22	8:30 PM

The Milky Way stretches overhead and down to the Southwest in Sagittarius, and to the Northeast in Auriga. Scanning through the Milky Way constellations with a telescope or binoculars can be surprising: several star clusters, particularly in Cassiopeia, Perseus, and Auriga will pop into view. A small telescope can find the Jewel Box Cluster (M11) in Sperm, the globular M15 in Pegasus, the planetary nebulas M 27 in Vulpecula and the Ring Nebula (M57) in Lyra, and of course the Andromeda Galaxy (M 31). Finally the Pleiades (M 45) is rising in the East, starting the progression to the winter constellations in coming months.

Larger telescopes might attempt some of the more challenging targets: the Helix Nebula (C 63), the Triangulum Galaxy (M 33), the edge-on galaxy C 23 (NGC 891), the “Blue Snowball” C22 (NGC 7662), as well as looking for the fainter moons of Saturn, or resolving Uranus and Neptune.